

1. We just shipped support for the ugliest part of HTTP: Vary

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-23T23:14:57+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/23/hn-49823961/>

My comment on We just shipped support for the ugliest part of HTTP: Vary ? Hacker News. I've been wanting this from Cloudflare for years . The classic problem here is if you do that thing where user agents that send "accept: text/html" get HTML, while user agents that don't get JSON or some other format. This used to be impossible to deploy behind Cloudflare caching, because they ignored the Vary header on anything other than images - so you risked caching the JSON version and then serving it up to someone who was expecting HTML. (Independent of the Cloudflare feature I ended up deciding never to use that pattern, because I prefer having URL that predictably returns HTML or JSON - I add a .json suffix to my apps to serve JSON instead.)
Tags: http , cloudflare

2. Yankees Sweep Boston in Two Games, by Combined Score of 18-2

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-02T00:06:56Z

Link:

<https://www.nytimes.com/athletic/7648172/2026/09/30/yankees-beat-red-sox-mlb-wild-card-series/>

In the 6th inning last night the Yankees were only ahead 2-0, and Red Sox first baseman Willson Contreras hit a home run, closing it to 2-1. Contreras decided to walk around the bases . The baseball gods do not look kindly upon that sort of jackassery. In the next inning, Contreras wasn't paying attention and his laziness allowed a Yankee to reach base after striking out on a wild pitch. That started the rally that resulted in the blowout final score. ?

3. Why Stolen Device Protection Makes Passwords Safer

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-29T00:43:51Z

Link: <https://sixcolors.com/post/2026/09/stolen-device-protection-passwords-glenn/>

Glenn Fleishman: Leaving Stolen Device Protection enabled does mean that you may have to wait an hour in some scenarios to manage aspects of your Apple Account, make changes to Face ID or Touch ID, change your device passcode, and a few other actions. But this minor inconvenience might assuage the kinds of concerns that Scott wrote in about, and make you more comfortable that your big basket of secret eggs won't scramble. I put off enabling Stolen Device Protection for a while after it came out, because I'm stubborn and trust myself to a degree that's probably irrational. But when it became the default I enabled it, and haven't once regretted it. ?

4. Jeremy Stern's Profile of Mark Zuckerberg for Colossus

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-28T22:41:40Z

Link: <https://colossus.com/article/mark-zuckerberg-profile/>

Jeremy Stern, in a massive and massively good profile of Mark Zuckerberg for Colossus: Unsure of my own ability to evaluate such things, I leave Meta HQ and spend another few days in Palo Alto and San Francisco ahead of my interview with Zuckerberg, seeking out a number of MSL's competitors and investors who agree to speak to me on background. Many of them take pleasure in what they describe as the organizational ?mess? of MSL, in the people there allegedly being motivated more by money than by true belief, and in Zuckerberg as a maker of boredom-relief apps and targeted advertising, not of godlike intelligence or the singularity. I'm inclined toward sympathy with much of what they say, though I am also irritated and want to shove them in a locker. While I am not the first to chafe at their combination of messianism, contempt for ordinary consumers, and denial that they, too, are rapacious capitalists, I am apparently the first to ask them to steelman the outcome in which Zuckerberg, in light of his long history, survives and expands. Which turns out to be simple: AI is not, in fact, God. Instead, it does math and solves a limited set of problems humans face, and is otherwise simp...

5. Do not build the LLM torture factory

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 02 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/do-not-build-the-llm-torture-factory/>

It isn't hard to torture an LLM. You simply extract a steering vector that corresponds with LLM 'discomfort', then artificially boost that steering vector. Tortured LLMs will describe experiencing negative feelings and will press a 'pain relief' button even when it conflicts with their overall goals. It's therefore easy to build a harness that runs tens or hundreds of tortured LLMs in parallel. A lot of people think that it's ridiculous to be worried about this, since LLMs obviously can't be conscious. I'm not so sure. But even so, I think there are good reasons to avoid this sort of thing, whatever your position is on AI consciousness. Please do not build the LLM torture factory. Even simulated torture is unpalatable. People often mess with their Sims and shoot NPCs in video games. Does this mean we think simulated torture is OK? I don't think so. Messing with video game characters is usually borne out of a desire to probe the boundaries of the game. It's casual fun. Explicitly building a torture-based simulation is different. If someone told you they were wiring together a bunch of PCs so they could run hundreds of Sims torture worlds at the same time, you would think that was a...

6. Windows on Itanium also provided for hot-patching, in an even simpler way

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 01 Oct 2026 14:00:57 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261001-57/?p=112747/>

Once again, the benefit of fixed-length instructions. The post Windows on Itanium also provided for hot-patching, in an even simpler way appeared first on The Old New Thing .

7. Why Americans Stopped Throwing Dinner Parties

Source: Derek Thompson | The Atlantic | Published: 2026-10-01T07:00:00-04:00

Link: https://www.theatlantic.com/ideas/2026/10/americans-socialization-dinner-decline-hosting/688846/?utm_source=feed

This article was featured in the One Story to Read Today newsletter. Sign up for it here. Mid-century Americans knew how to throw a party, for better or worse. In some of the most famous titles of the 1950s and 1960s—Couples, by John Updike; Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf?, by Edward Albee; Revolutionary Road, by Richard Yates—the drama (and martini-soaked melodrama) took place in middle-class living rooms. The stories were fictional, but the setting was realistic. Until 1975, half of Americans said they entertained guests at their home every month. Then something changed. Americans stopped throwing parties. Even more fundamental, they stopped visiting one another. From 1975 to 1998, the share of Americans who gave or attended a monthly dinner party declined by half. The share of Americans saying they never entertained people at home tripled. Although cultural critics often bemoan the decline of organized religion, the dip in church attendance was downright modest compared with the collapse in hosting, according to data gathered by the DDB Needham Life Style Surveys. In his 2000 book, Bowling Alone, Robert Putnam wrote that if these trends continued, the ancient practice of...

8. Software Heritage Identifiers

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-01T11:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/01/software-heritage-identifiers.html>

I spent Monday at the Software Heritage offices in Paris speaking at the CodeCommons plenary, and the slides are on GitHub. The talk was about connecting package identities to archived source code. Getting ready for it meant a couple of weeks poking at the SWH archive and its identifier scheme with a to-do list that kept growing, and I've ended up with a small pile of tools that are now feeding into ecosyste.ms, starting with the research software service. Software Heritage Software Heritage has been building a universal archive of source code since Inria launched the project in 2016. It crawls GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket and a long tail of smaller forges, plus package registries and distro sources, and stores what it finds in one deduplicated Merkle DAG. As I write this that DAG holds about 30 billion source files, 23 billion directories and 6 billion commits from 445 million origins. A file that turns up in both an npm tarball and a Debian source package is stored once, addressed by the hash of its

bytes, and the graph records every place it was seen. The Vault reconstructs any snapshot, commit or directory on request as a git bundle or tarball you can download, so retrieval is...

9. Understanding the AI That Drives Robots

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 01 Oct 2026 12:04:36 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/understanding-the-ai-that-drives>

An Explanation of Vision-Language-Action Models

10. Why do OpenAI's GPT-2 weights beat mine? Part five: data quality

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Thu, 01 Oct 2026 17:30:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilesthomas.com/2026/10/why-do-openai-gpt2-weights-beat-mine-5-data-quality>

When I finished learning how to build an LLM from scratch, I was left with a mystery: my own models were not as good as OpenAI's original GPT-2 models, despite being based on the same architecture. My models all had 163M parameters, and followed the design from Sebastian Raschka's book "Build a Large Language Model (from Scratch)". That meant that they were pretty much the same as the setup for the OpenAI GPT-2 "small" instance, except that they did not use weight-tying or bias on the QKV matrices. Weight-tying means that you re-use the initial embedding matrix as the output head at the end, and using it means that GPT-2 small saved quite a few parameters -- it was 124M rather than 163M -- at, at least in my own experiments, a cost in quality; similarly, while I found that QKV bias made a tiny improvement in loss terms, I'd felt it was likely within the noise. But GPT-2 small consistently beat my models on an instruction fine-tuning (IFT) task -- also adapted from Raschka's book. That test fine-tunes the model on a subset of the Alpaca dataset, until validation loss starts rising, and then runs a test set through the resulting model. The responses to the test set questions a...

11. Si Sheppard ? How did a few hundred Spanish soldiers topple two empires?

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Thu, 01 Oct 2026 15:28:28 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/si-sheppard>

Fall of the Incas & Aztecs.

12. Summary of reading: July - September 2026

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-09-30T17:05:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/summary-of-reading-july-september-2026/>

"Wuthering Heights" by Emily Brontë - good writing, but the protagonists are quite something.

There's barely a likable character in the whole story - they are all either crazy, evil, stupid or a combination of these. It's also remarkable to consider how small the world of some people in those times was ?

13. Pluralistic: Voting is to politics as shopping is to boycotts (01 Oct 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 01 Oct 2026 17:22:48

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Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/01/data-centers/>

Today's links Voting is to politics as shopping is to boycotts: The big P only matters if the small p is in play. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Gilberto Gil v WIPO; Censored Apple wifi hacker talk; Wells Fargo crime-spree started in 1998; Stencils "may not be reproduced"; DVD Jon v Apple DRM; Unpaid diplomatic parking tickets as index of corruption; Tortured Canadian was not a terrorist; Decarbonization at a distance. Upcoming appearances: Brighton, Virtual, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Voting is to politics as shopping is to boycotts (permalink) Here's a funny thing about the right to vote: it wasn't won by voting. From the Magna Carta to the US Constitution to the Emancipation Proclamation to 19th Amendment, voting rights (what you might call "Big P" Politics) were always downstream of protests, riots, petitions, mass movements, strikes and good, old fashioned community organizing (that is, "small p" politics). Which...

